A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

17 April 2026

Alicia ALTSON

Dear Alicia ALTSON,

Re: Ms Matilda MAYNARD
DOB: 2001-08-10
Address: 13 Marabou Place, ASPENDALE, VIC, 3195

Summary

- **Improvement in symptoms of cramping and emesis following the initiation of nortriptyline.**
- **Persistent abdominal bloating and infrequent flatulence, potentially related to pelvic floor dysfunction or dysmotility.**
- **Recent laparoscopy findings of significant pelvic adhesions and a 6-7 cm left ovarian cyst.**
- **Referral to endocrinology for evaluation of hair loss, weight gain, and skin changes.**
- **Planned intestinal ultrasound and a trial of rifaximin if bloating remains refractory.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of reviewing Matilda following her recent laparoscopy and the initiation of her new medication regimen. Since our last review, Matilda has commenced nortriptyline, which she is currently taking at a dose of 20 mg nocte. She reports some nocturnal drowsiness, but this has not impacted her daytime functioning.

Clinically, there appears to be a positive response to the nortriptyline. Matilda notes a reduction in the frequency and severity of abdominal cramping and episodes of emesis over the past month. Despite this, she continues to suffer from significant and persistent abdominal bloating. She also noted an occasional return of minor rectal bleeding. It is worth noting that she experienced a temporary exacerbation of symptoms while at home, which improved when she returned to her work environment, likely due to dietary changes and reduced consumption of processed foods.

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
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Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
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Matilda underwent a laparoscopy last Wednesday, which revealed extensive scar tissue and adhesions, particularly on the right side. A 6-7 cm cyst was identified on her left ovary and addressed surgically. Interestingly, there was no evidence of recurrent endometriosis, and her Mirena device was replaced. We discussed the possibility that her persistent bloating and difficulty passing flatus may be related to pelvic floor hypertonicity, which is common in patients with a history of chronic pelvic pain and endometriosis.

Beyond her gastrointestinal symptoms, Matilda remains concerned regarding significant hair loss, weight gain, and skin changes over the last two years. While my previous screening for Cushing's syndrome and Addison's disease returned normal results, she feels strongly that a hormonal or metabolic driver remains. I have facilitated a referral to an endocrinologist, Dr Melissa Lee, for a formal assessment of these systemic issues. Matilda will also discuss a potential dermatology referral with you in due course. **Melissa Could you please accept this letter as a referral letter for Matildas case, she has concerns around hormonal changes which may explain hair loss and weight gain.**

Impression and Plan My clinical impression is that Matilda's abdominal pain and emesis are partially responsive to neuromodulation, though her bloating remains a significant functional challenge. I have advised her to increase the nortriptyline dose to 25 mg daily, with a view to escalating to 37.5 mg if tolerated. To further investigate her bloating and infrequent flatulence, I have requested an intestinal ultrasound to exclude an unusual presentation of small bowel Crohn's disease or features of intestinal dysmotility/strictures.

If her bloating does not improve over the next two months, I have provided a prescription for a two-week course of compounded rifaximin to address possible small intestinal bacterial overgrowth or dysbiosis. I have asked Matilda to observe the effects of her pelvic floor physiotherapy once she has recovered sufficiently from her recent surgery. I will review her progress in three months' time.

Kind regards

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

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CC: Dr Melissa Lee, A/Prof Pav Nanayakkara

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